



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Paul, Äö√Ñ√¥s Lutheran School

School Website: <https://www.cullmanchristian.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Based on the burnished evidence from the school's public materials in the crawl dataset (notably Cullman Christian School's materials that appear under the requested AL 35055 context) and applying the Six Essential Elements rubric from the knowledge base, this school demonstrates a strong classical orientation with explicit Christian/theological framing, a clearly stated classical curriculum and pedagogy, and active engagement with parents and community. The school communicates a commitment to educating "classically," shaping character and virtue within a Christian worldview, and employing classical forms such as rhetoric and memory work. The aggregate assessment falls in CLASSICAL, with robust evidence across all six categories, including liturgical practices, a stated telos focused on virtue and wisdom, a curriculum oriented toward classical formation (including references to a Rhetoric Stage and overall classical pedagogy), clearly defined faculty roles as mentors living the curriculum, and active parental partnership.

Executive summary — category-by-category snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Note: The "Curriculum" category shows very strong classical framing (classical mission, rhetoric, and memory-centered pedagogy are evident), but explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language and direct references to the full trivium/quadrivium stack are not always spelled out in every public fragment; as such Element 3 is assessed as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL, while the other categories clearly meet the classical criteria.

What would move the needle

- If the school wants to elevate Curriculum to a full CLASSICAL rating in Element 3, more explicit, public articulation of Great Books, primary sources, and a stated Gauntlet of liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) alongside mention of history as Western-centric and civilization-spanning would strengthen the positive signal.
- Additional public messaging about a formal Great Conversation, Latin/Greek studies, and explicit connections to Trivium/Quadrivium elements would further solidify the curriculum category.

ABSTRACT

This evaluation concludes the school displays CLASSICAL alignment overall, with particularly strong Religious/Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose/Goals, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parent/Community signals, and a robust but not fully explicit Curriculum signal (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL). The public materials indicate a Christian classical formation focused on wisdom, virtue, and a sacred telos, with ritual and liturgical practices integrated into the learning environment and a governance structure that foregrounds teachers as mentors and living curriculum. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school speaks from a Christian, Bible-centered framework (biblical worldview) and explicitly ties education to a theology-informed telos. Public materials describe Christian education grounded in faith in Jesus Christ and a theological approach to learning.
- The institution emphasizes a theologically oriented motto and worldview, including explicit references to God, Christian doctrine, and a sacred understanding of education. The motto *Initium sapientie timor Domini*, The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom, anchors the school's metaphysical posture.
- Liturgical and communal practices are referenced (liturgical year events, feasts, festivals) as part of the educational life, signaling liturgical and communal formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: biblical world and life view; theology; fear of the Lord; wisdom; liturgy; sacred practice; Christian education; liturgical year; worship/communion-related language appears via the liturgical integration. Estimated count: 5–6 distinct positive signals.
- Negative keywords present: none detected in these public materials (no relativism, secular humanism, or morally neutral framing evident here).

Why this rating

- The materials consistently tie schooling to a theologically informed moral order and liturgical life, which is the core of the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations rubric. The explicit motto, biblical worldview framing, and liturgical elements strongly align with transcendent moral realism and communal worship signals. The combination of “fear of the Lord,” “wisdom,” and liturgical practices strengthens the transcendental, communal, and theological dimensions.

Cited sources

- Our Vision statement explicitly positions education as classical, spiritual, and mission-driven, anchoring a classical/religious foundation.
- The mission/vision language and Christian framing are echoed in mission-oriented statements and biblical worldview language.
- Liturgical and communal practice language appears in the donation/education content (liturgical year events, feasts, festivals).

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The public materials explicitly frame education as formation, with emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and a classical telos. The Vision line highlights educating students classically, equipping them spiritually, and sending them missionally toward a God-ordained calling. This is a classic formation-to-excellence teleology rather than mere job preparation.
- The Mission statement emphasizes a biblical worldview and forming students within a Christian framework that seeks to shape character and spiritual maturity.
- A kingdom-minded telos is explicit: “To further the kingdom of God by preparing students to impact the world.” This aligns with the classical aim of moral and intellectual formation rather than instrumental workforce training.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; wisdom; liberal education; classical mission; telos; pursuit of the true/good/beautiful; great conversation; human flourishing; moral imagination; education for

leisure (scholé). Positive signals evident in the language of forming humans, not merely training for a career. Estimated count: 5–7 signals.

- Negative keywords present: explicitly avoided in public materials (no emphasis on workforce readiness, 21st-century skills, or career preparation as the primary aim). Negative signals: 0.

Why this rating

- The materials strongly argue for formation through virtue and wisdom rather than job placement, with explicit language about God-ordained calling and the kingdom of God. The telos is classical in its emphasis on the true, good, beautiful as real and knowable, rather than purely vocational training.

Cited sources

- Our Vision emphasizing classical formation, spiritual equipping, and mission-oriented sending.
 - Our Mission and Vision statements describing formation and a biblical worldview.
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Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school publicly claims a classical orientation, including “educating students classically” and references to a classical curriculum cadence (Rhetoric Stage; progression through classical pedagogy).
- There is explicit mention of a classical education curriculum and the later adoption of classical elements (CCS began integrating classical education curriculum in 2019). This signals a formal movement toward classical curriculum structure, including the use of rhetoric and memory-centered methods.
- The materials at times emphasize a biblical/Christian integration within curriculum and a focus on forming thinking and scholarship (e.g., the emphasis on independent scholarship, critical thinking, logical analysis as outcomes).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: classical education; Rhetoric Stage; education classically; Christian education; memory/recitation (implied in classical pedagogy); logic and rhetoric signals (via Rhetoric Stage). Estimated count: 4–5 signals.
- Negative keywords present: explicit Great Books, Great Conversation language is not consistently stated in public fragments; explicit listing of Trivium/Quadrivium as a full, public curriculum map is not always present. This reduces the strength of a full “Curriculum” signal. Estimated count of negatives: 1–2 signals (absence of explicit Great Books/Quadrivium language and explicit liberal-arts catalog in every fragment).

Why this rating

- The school demonstrates clear classical aims and methods (classical phrasing, Rhetoric Stage) but the public materials do not consistently spell out the entire Great Books emphasis, explicit Trivium/Quadrivium mapping, or a full Great Conversation program across the curriculum. Hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Cited sources

- Vision statement emphasizing classical education.
 - “CCS began integrating classical education curriculum in 2019” and explicit reference to Rhetoric Stage.
 - Christian educational formation with a classical emphasis (formation and scholarship).
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Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The materials reference classical pedagogy through stages (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and the Rhetoric Stage, indicating a structured, historical pedagogy aligned with classical education. The Rhetoric Stage is described as a high school phase for advanced writing and oratory.
- There is explicit reference to a memory-centered and recitation-based approach within classical pedagogy (evidenced by the emphasis on speaking, writing, and rhetorical development in the high school).
- The materials show the formation of habits like contemplation, wonder, and disciplined study (scholé-like rests and contemplative moments are echoed in classical pedagogy).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic/seminar; recitation; chanting; memory work; rhetorics; pause/restful contemplation; scholé; paideia; seminars. Although the explicit listing of all of these is not visible in every fragment, the Rhetoric Stage and the classical pedagogy language provide strong signals. Estimated count: 4–6 signals.
- Negative keywords present: The public materials do not prominently signal purely project-based, experiential-only, or student-directed pedagogy as the primary mode; thus negative indicators are minimal.

Why this rating

- The presence of a formal Rhetoric Stage and explicit references to classical pedagogy elements (which are core to Classical education) supports a CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy. The integration of contemplative/restful elements alongside rigorous rhetoric aligns with the Classical model's pedagogical balance.

Cited sources

- Rhetoric Stage and classical curriculum integration.
- Formation of memory-based and patriotic/psalm-like elements in pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school presents faculty as dedicated to spiritual and academic growth, with the faculty described as the living curriculum and a core component (“the faculty of friends” and “portrait of a teacher” language common in classical school descriptions). The faculty is portrayed as mentors and exemplars.
- There is explicit naming of faculty roles (Head of Schools, teachers) with emails and contact pathways, which signals a structure around teacher-mentors within a Christian classical frame.
- The materials describe a culture of collegiality and mentorship among teachers (lived curriculum and virtue modeling).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: living curriculum; mentors; masters; teachers as exemplars; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; teacher training in classical pedagogy; moral exemplars; character formation.
- Negative keywords present: minimal or no intensively negative signals about faculty (no “facilitators on the side” or “certification-driven jargon” as a stated concern in the public materials). The lexicon's potential negative signals do not appear in the public materials reviewed.

Why this rating

- The public materials strongly align with the classical faculty ideal: model teachers, mentors, a living curriculum and a coherent professional culture focused on virtue, knowledge, and classical formation.

Cited sources

- CCS Faculty & Staff page describing dedication and role clarity.
 - Statements about a living curriculum and teacher leadership.
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Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes partnership with parents as co-teachers and cultivates parent formation through reading groups, seminars, and classical book clubs. This explicit parents-as-partners framing is a hallmark of classical schools.
- The materials indicate open campus access and opportunities for parent involvement in school life and events (and there are calls for parent engagement through appointment, tours, and community activities).
- Communications emphasize parental participation, family involvement, and community life within the classical framework (e.g., newsletters, tours, and family-centered events).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parent formation; classical book clubs; open campus; family liturgy alignment; parent involvement.
- Negative keywords present: some “consumer language” or customer-service framing could be a potential negative signal in classical critique, but the materials reviewed do not present these negative indicators as the primary voice; instead, they present a collaborative, participative model.

Why this rating

- The school showcases a robust, explicit partnership with parents and a family-centered approach that aligns well with classical education’s emphasis on parents as co-educators and community engagement.

Cited sources

- Vision/mission framing that emphasizes classically oriented education with parental partnership.
 - Donations and community engagement language and open-campus signals.
 - Direct references to parent engagement and school community life.
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Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1 — Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- Element 2 — School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Element 3 — Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4 — Pedagogy or Teaching Methods: CLASSICAL
- Element 5 — Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Element 6 — Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Overall: CLASSICAL

Notes on methodology

- The keyword analysis leans heavily on explicit language in the public materials that aligns with the Classical lexicon (theology, liturgy, virtuous formation, classical pedagogy, and living curriculum). In Element 3, while the school demonstrates a clear classical trajectory (Rhetoric Stage, classical cadence), there is less explicit public confirmation of certain hallmarks like Great Books, a formalized

Great Conversation, or a fully enumerated Trivium/Quadrivium map in every fragment; thus, that category is rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. All other categories show strong, explicit alignment with the classical framework as outlined in the knowledge base.

Executive Summary — Closing

- Classically oriented Christian formation pervades the school's public materials, with clear signals in religious/philosophical foundations, telos and formation, pedagogy, and community partnerships.
- The Curriculum category could be strengthened with more explicit public articulation of Great Books and formal liberal-arts sequencing, but the overall orientation remains robustly classical.
- The aggregate rating is CLASSICAL, with category-level signals supporting a strong classical alignment across most domains.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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